AA–F–360
MARCH 14, 1956

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA–F–00325 (GSA–FSS)
27 January 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILING CABINETS, STEEL, MAP AND PLAN (SECTIONAL)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers steel sectional filing cabinet units which intermember and stack vertically. The cabinet sections are intended for the routine, horizontal filing and storing of drawings, maps, plans and similar semi-active records up to 48 inches long by 36 inches wide.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Units and sizes.*—The sections covered by this specification shall consist of the following units and sizes as specified in the invitation for bids (see fig. 1 and 3.2.3):

Unit 1.—Base sections
- Size 1.—For drawings up to 36 by 24 inches
- Size 2.—For drawings up to 42 by 30 inches
- Size 3.—For drawings up to 48 by 36 inches

Unit 2.—5-drawer sections
- Size 1.—For drawings up to 36 by 24 inches
- Size 2.—For drawings up to 42 by 30 inches
- Size 3.—For drawings up to 48 by 36 inches

Unit 3.—Top sections
- Size 1.—For drawings up to 36 by 24 inches.
- Size 2.—For drawings up to 42 by 30 inches
- Size 3.—For drawings up to 48 by 36 inches

1.2.2 *Colors of finish.*—The cabinets shall be of the following colors, as specified in the invitation for bids, and the colors shall match the standard colors of finish adopted by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration:

Gray
Olive Green

(Sample panels of the standard colors of finish are obtainable without charge, from the Business Service Center, Regional Office Building, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C. or from the Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification:

Federal Specification:

LLL–B–631—Boxes, Fiber, Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment)

Military Specifications

MIL–A–101—Adhesive, Water-Resistant, for Sealing Fiberboard Boxes

JAN–P–108—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes, Fiberboard (V-Board and W-Board), Exterior and Interior.

JAN–P–127—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Tape, Adhesive, Pressure-Sensitive, Water-Resistant.

JAN–P–132—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Crates; Unsheathed,

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Wood; Nailed (for Maximum Net Load of 2,500 Pounds).

MIL–A–140 — Adhesive, Water-Resistant, Waterproof Barrier-Material

MIL–C–490—Cleaning and Preparation of Ferrous and Zinc Coated Surfaces for Organic Protective Coatings

MIL–L–10547—Liners Case Waterproof

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage

MIL–STD–130—Identification Marking of U S Military Property

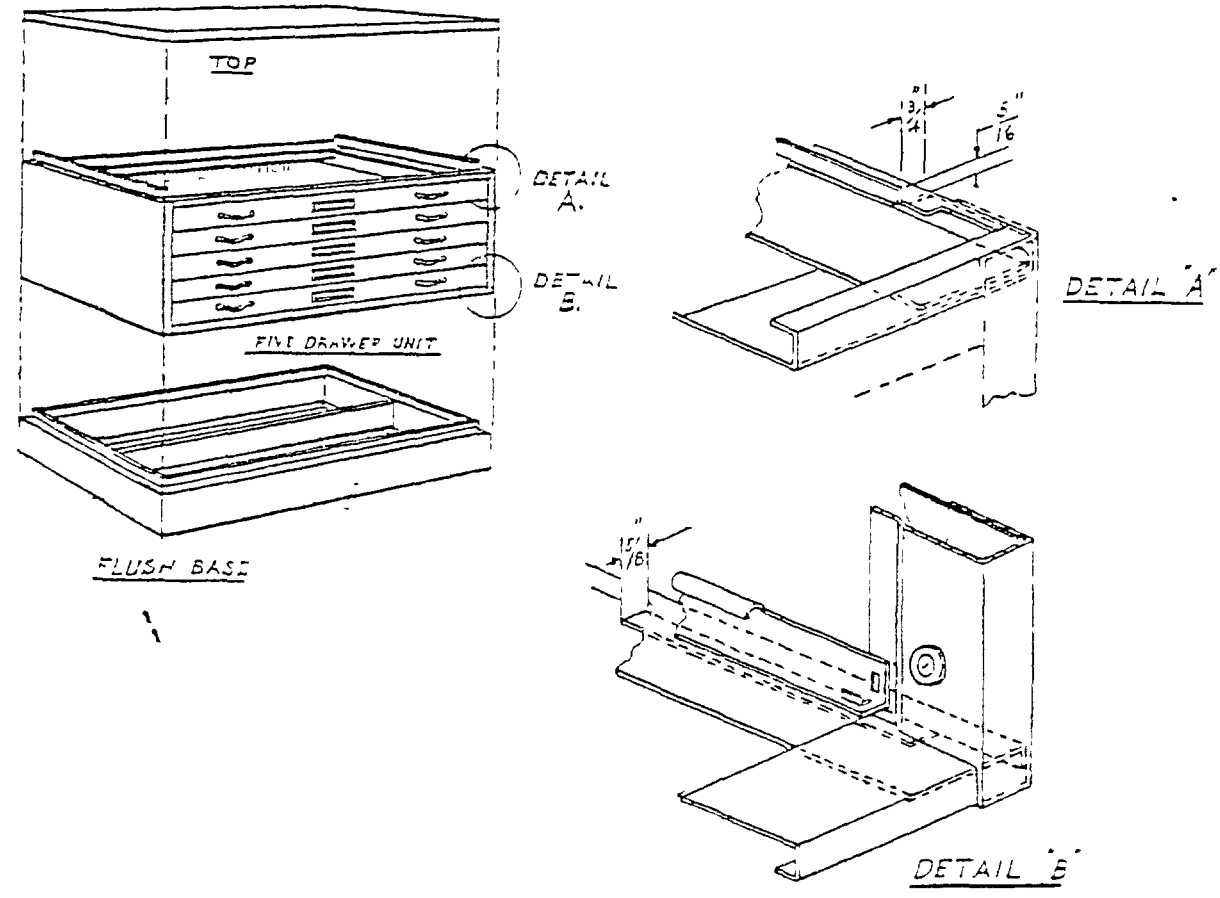


FIGURE 1 —Filing cabinets, steel, map and plan.

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by non-governmental activities for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo , Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D C

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(Copies of Military Standards and Military Specifications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Steel*—The steel used in the fabrication of the drawer sections, tops, and bases shall be of commercial quality, cold rolled, oiled, hot rolled, pickled and oiled, and hot-rolled annealed, of the respective thicknesses shown in table I and shall withstand the bend test specified in 4.3.1 Cold rolled steel shall be used for the base and for the cabinet sides backs tops and drawer sides and fronts Hot-rolled pickled and oiled steel shall be used for heavy interior structural parts where good welding is of primary importance Hot-rolled annealed steel shall be used for drawer bottoms, backs, partitions, and interior drawer fronts The steel shall be bright, smooth, free from rust, loose scale, pits, scratches, laps, crimps, and buckles The gage numbers specified in table I are the Manufacturers' Standard Gage for Steel Sheets The decimal equivalents shown for the steel sheet thicknesses are subject to the established standard tolerances.

TABLE I—*Steel sheet gage numbers*

Parts	Minimum	Inch thickness (nominal)
Front vertical members	14	0 0747
Back vertical members	14	0747
Intermediate vertical members	16	0598
Horizontal end members	16	0598
Horizontal front members	14	0747
Horizontal back members	18	0478
End Panels	20	0359
Back panel	22	0299
Drawer suspension channels	16	0598
Drawer sides or rails	16	0598
Drawer bottom or body	22	0299
Drawer back and hood	22	0299
Inside drawer head	22	0299
Drawer front	20	0359
Top panel	18	0478
Top reinforcements	16	0598
Base frame	16	0598
Gussets	16	0598
Stretcher	16	0598

3.1.2 *Hardware*

3.1.2.1 *Face hardware*—The face hardware shall be satin finished anodized or lacquered aluminum commercial type 430 stainless steel or polished chromium or brushed chromium on steel, or on die-cast brass, bronze or zinc

3.1.2.2 *Drawer pulls*—The drawer pulls shall be of the materials and finishes specified in 3 1 2 1 The pulls shall be of the regular commercial design with all surfaces and edges ground smooth to eliminate roughness and sharp edges Pulls shall be securely attached with screws or with nuts and lock-washers which shall be countersunk on the inside of the double wall Pulls may be staggered

3.1.2.3 *Label holders*—The label holders shall be of the material specified in 3.1 2 1 and shall be not less than 20-gage (0 0359 inch) thick The label holder shall be secured to the drawer front by not less than two screws, or by welding or other suitable means, and shall readily accommodate a label card not less than 6 inches long by 1¼ inches high Label holders may be finished the same as the drawer front

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3.1.2.4 *Locks*.—When specified in the invitation for bids, automatic unit locks shall be supplied on drawer sections. The locking mechanism shall be controlled by a paracentric key lock, which shall have not less than four pin-tumblers and shall have not less than 200 key changes. The face of the lock shall be of the material specified in 3.1.2.1 and two keys shall be supplied with each lock. The locking mechanism shall be so constructed that the drawers left open may be closed and locked after the cabinet is locked.

3.1.2.5 *Rollers*.—Fixed type drawer rollers which are attached to the drawer or the case shall be the anti-friction ball bearing type not less than 1 inch in diameter with a $\frac{9}{16}$-inch face. Floating-type drawer support rollers if used, shall be not less than ½-inch diameter and $\frac{5}{16}$ inch thick. Rollers shall be drive or forced fit and properly hardened.

3.1.2.6 *Bolts, nuts, and screws*.—Bolts, nuts, and screws used for necessary mechanical joints shall be zinc or cadmium plated. Exposed heads may be finished the same as the cabinet.

3.1.3 *Finishing materials*.

3.1.3.1 *Cleaning*.—All metal surfaces, except finished hardware shall be cleaned and surface preparation processed in accordance with any of the grades or types specified in Military Specification MIL-C-490, Cleaning and Preparation of Ferrous and Zinc Coated Surfaces for Organic Protective Coatings.

3.1.3.2 *Enamel*.—The quality of enamel for the finish coat shall be in accordance with the filing cabinet manufacturers' regular commercial products, except that the colors shall be as specified in 1.2.2 of this specification, and the enamel shall be baked for not less than 45 minutes or in accordance with the enamel manufacturer's directions. Finish shall withstand the test specified in 4.3.2. In addition a final coat of lacquer may be acceptable.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 *Design*.—The sections shall be of the horizontal sectional type similar to figure 1 with the drawer sections, bases and tops provided with specified standard intermembering features which will permit the secure stacking vertically of any contractor's products.

3.2.1.1 *Standard intermembering features*.—To permit the intermembering of any contractor's products, flanges of the dimensions specified in table II shall be provided on all four sides or on either of the two opposite sides on any intermembering section. If intermembering flanges are provided on only two sides, the opposite sides shall be free of obstructions that would prohibit intermembering with specified flanges.

3.2.2 *Assembly*.—Assembly of parts shall be by welding to the greatest extent practicable. Welding methods and procedures shall be those presently used in regular commercial production that will insure maximum strength so that no parts will work loose when subjected to the

TABLE II.—*Dimensions (inches)*

Classification	Item name	Overall (exposed)			Inside drawer			Standard intermembering components	
		Width	Depth	Height	Width	Depth	Height	Horizontal Flange	Vertical Flange
Unit 1, size 1	Base Section	40¾	28⅞	4				¾ top	5/16
Unit 1, size 2	Base Section	46¾	35⅞	4				¾ top	5/16
Unit 1, size 3	Base Section	53¾	41⅞	4				¾ top	5/16
Unit 2, size 1	Drawer Section	40¾	28⅞	15⅜	37	26	1 15/16	¾ top, ⅝ bottom	5/16
Unit 2, size 2	Drawer Section	46¾	35⅞	15⅜	43	32	1 15/16	¾ top, ⅝ bottom	5/16
Unit 2, size 3	Drawer Section	53¾	41⅞	15⅜	50	38	1 15/16	¾ top, ⅝ bottom	5/16
Unit 3, size 1	Top Section	40¾	29¼	¾				⅝ bottom	None
Unit 3, size 2	Top Section	46¾	36¼	¾				⅝ bottom	None
Unit 3, size 3	Top Section	53¾	42¼	¾				⅝ bottom	None

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strains, jars, vibrations and other conditions incident to shipping, storage and usage under normal daily operations during the lifetime of the units

3.2.3 *Dimensions*—The sections shall be in strict accordance with the dimensions specified in table II and the tolerances specified herein

3.2.3.1 *Tolerances*—A plus or minus tolerance of 1/16 inch will be permitted on the over-all widths and depths The over-all heights and inside drawer dimensions are minimum requirements A tolerance of plus or minus 1/16 inch will be permitted in the horizontal and vertical intermembering flanges

3.2.4 *Unit 1, base*—The bases shall be flush type of the open-frame design similar to figure 1 and shall be formed from the steel specified in 3 1 1, of the minimum gages shown in table I and to the dimensions shown in table II All base bottom edges shall be flanged in not less than 5/8 inch with flanges either offset and overlapped or mitered and securely welded at the corners Bottom surfaces shall be level and smooth Base frame joints shall be at the rear or ends of the base and shall be reinforced on the inside by a steel backing plate not less than 3½ inches high which shall be securely welded in place A reinforcing stretcher not less than 3½ inches high shall be provided in the center of each base and running from side to side or from front to rear The stretcher shall be flanged on the top and bottom and shall be welded to the upper and lower horizontal flanges on the inside sides or front and back of the base Alternatively steel gussets shall be provided at each corner and shall be not less than 6 inches long and securely welded to the joining members The top of the base shall be flanged in ¾ inch horizontally and then 5/16 inch vertically to serve as the intermembering member

3.2.5 *Unit 2, five-drawer section*—The five-drawer section shall consist of the case and five drawers similar to figure 1. The case frame shall be constructed of vertical and horizontal members of the steel specified in 3.1.1, formed for rigidity and flanged as specified in table II for intermembering with other units when stacked one above the other. The frame members shall be of the gage of steel specified in table I and shall be securely welded together. The frame members shall overlap or be reinforced by gussets to form a rigid frame. Panels shall be not less than the gage of steel specified in table I and shall be flanged to overlap the frame at the top and the bottom edges Vertical joints must be nested, flanged or offset to present a smooth finished appearance Panels and frame shall be securely welded together All welding shall be as specified in 3.2 2

3.2.5.1 *Drawers*—The drawers shall be similar to figure 1 of the sizes specified in table II for the size of cabinet ordered, (see 1.2.1) The drawers shall be formed of the gage of steel specified in table I and reinforced, shaped, and welded into a rigid drawer that will not warp, twist, sag or bind in operation The drawer front shall have a double wall and the outside front shall have not less than a 3/8-inch channel all the way around with the corners tightly closed, and the side and bottom channels flanged for welding to the drawer side and bottom The inside drawer front shall be flanged along the top edge and shall fit inside the top channel of the outside drawer front The inside front, bottom and back may be formed from one piece The bottom edge of drawer sides shall be flanged inward for welding to the drawer bottom The drawer bottom shall be punched for partitions so that the drawer may be evenly divided into 2 4 6 or 8 compartments The drawer rear hood shall be not less than 2 inches wide, and shall be either fixed or floating type, either separate or part of the drawer back, with the front edge beaded or folded over for strength. The drawer shall be equipped with pulls and label holders as specified in 3 1.2.2 and 3.1.2 3

3.2.5.2 *Drawer compressor*—Unless otherwise specified, the front of all drawers shall be equipped with a link hinge type compressor or paper weight. The compressor shall be formed of not less than 20-gage (0.0359 inch) steel and be designed to lay flat at all compressing positions, and shall fold clear of the drawer for convenient filing. The compressor shall be the full width of the drawer (minus approximately

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one inch) and shall extend into the drawer not less than four inches The flat part of the compressor shall be not less than two inches wide after forming the front and back edges into a bead or roll

3.2.5.3 *Drawer covers*.—When specified all drawers shall be provided with a waterproof coated fabric cover which shall compress and protect drawings from curling or damage in opening and closing of drawers The front edge of the cover shall have a full width, channel-shaped steel finger grip bar not less than ½ inch high, and shall be provided with a means of stretching and firmly holding the cover The covers shall be made of not less than the following weight material

45-inch	8.20 sheeting or drill	4 ounces per square yard
45-inch	8 12 sheeting or drill	3 9 ounces per square yard
54-inch	2.25 drill	4.2 ounces per square yard

The fabric covers shall be coated with compounded synthetic rubber or waterproof plastic coating weighing not less than 9 ounces per square yard The covers shall be seamed and folded, and firmly clinched into the steel finger grip bar and into the front edge of the rear hood or equivalent provision

3.2.5.4 *Drawer partitions*.—When specified drawer partitions forming either 2 4 6 or 8 compartments shall be furnished and shall be formed to provide a rear hood for each compartment They shall be easily secured through the holes punched in the drawer bottom and easily removed

3.2.5.5 *Drawer suspension*.—Either 4 fixed type rollers (2 secured to the front of the case and 2 secured to the rear part of the drawer or 4 floating-type rollers operating in the case slide and 2 fixed rollers at the rear of the drawer, shall be used to support each drawer. Rollers shall be as specified in 3 1 2 5, and suspension operation shall be efficient for the purpose intended. The drawer supporting member or rail shall be formed from the top of the drawer sides or shall be a channel formed from not less than 16-gage steel (0 0598 inch) and securely welded to drawer side The case suspension channels shall be securely welded, riveted, or notched or a combination thereof, to the vertical members of the case frame Out stops and anti-rebound features shall be provided to keep the drawers in a closed position

3.2.6 *Unit S tops*.—The top section shall be flush with the sides and back of drawer sections and the front edge shall project over the front of the drawer section The top shall be formed of the gage of steel specified in 3 1 1 and in table I and of the sizes specified in table II The top shall be reinforced by a heavy steel channel or angle not less than ⅝ inch by 1⅜ inches nominal running across the entire front and by channels running from front to back The channels shall be not less than 16-gage steel and not less than ⅝ inch high by 1 7/16 inches wide All reinforcements shall be spotwelded to the top plate Size 1 tops shall have one reinforcing channel and sizes 2 and 3 tops shall have two reinforcing channels The tops shall be accurately formed to intermember with the drawer sections and a means shall be provided to lock the tops to the drawer sections

3.3 **Finish.**—All exterior and interior steel surfaces of the cabinets except finished hardware, shall be prepared for painting in accordance with 3 1 3 1 All surfaces of the cabinets and drawers shall be coated with a baking enamel conforming to the requirements of 3 1 3 2 The minimum total finished film thickness of enamel shall be not less than 1 mil The finish shall level out to produce smooth, uniform exposed surfaces without runs wrinkles grit areas of thin film or no film and separation o color Special attention shall be given to the bases and to the interiors to insure that all surfaces are adequately protected against rust Finished panels shall withstand the test specified in 4 3 2

3.4 **Identification marking.**—Each item shall be permanently marked in a plain and legible manner and with the Federal Stock Number, the Federal Specification number, and the

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manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined

3.4.1 When specified, equipment assemblies and parts shall be marked for identification in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–130

3.5 **Workmanship.**—The workmanship shall be of a quality to produce a serviceable and neat item of equipment and to withstand hard daily usage, the features of which are The forming, folding or beading to prevent sharp exposed edges, tight seams, smooth straight bending of channels and flanges, and strength of welding and bracing, accuracy of moving parts, and the placing of drawer stops Each item shall be free from defects which affect the appearance or which may impair the serviceability

4 SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.1.1 *Inspection lot*.—Normally, the inspection lot size shall consist of all units submitted for inspection at one time

4.1.2 *Sampling for inspection*.—Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105

4.2 Inspection.—The cabinets shall be inspected to determine compliance with this specification as to workmanship materials design intermembering details of construction hardware finish marking and packing Inspection shall be made by a representative of the Government at any time during process of manufacture, or at point of delivery

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Bend tests for steel sheets*.—The steel sheets used for parts to be formed shall withstand a 180° bend at room temperature both with and across the grain without showing any crystallization, cracks or fractures on the outside of the bend

4.3.2 *Finish*.—A 20-gage steel test panel prepared in accordance with 3 3 shall be bent at room temperature around a ¼-inch rod to 180° without evidence of cracking flaking or loss of adhesion of enamel

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Levels of protection.—Subject commodity shall be packaged and packed for domestic shipment—immediate use, unless domestic shipment—storage or export shipment—commercial or export shipment—military, is specified (see 6 1)

5.2 For domestic shipment—immediate use.—Unless otherwise specified subject commodity shall be packed in containers which, together with packaging wrapping and inner packing are acceptable by common or other carriers for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies

5.3 For domestic shipment — storage. — When specified

5.3.1 The top section shall be packed for domestic shipment as specified in figure 2

5.3.2 *Drawer section*.—Fabric drawer dust covers or compressors shall be secured in position to drawer fronts by the use of wood shims or by any other method that will adequately secure them in position The drawer section shall then be completely wrapped or covered with cushioning material Cushioning material shall be wood-wool packing blankets cellulose wadding pads, macerated paper blankets, or wood-fiber felt blankets All cushioning material shall be built up to provide a thickness of not less than ¾ inch over top, sides, and ends of cabinet

5.3.2.1 Clearance shall be provided between the handles of the drawer section and the side of the shipping container by means of interior

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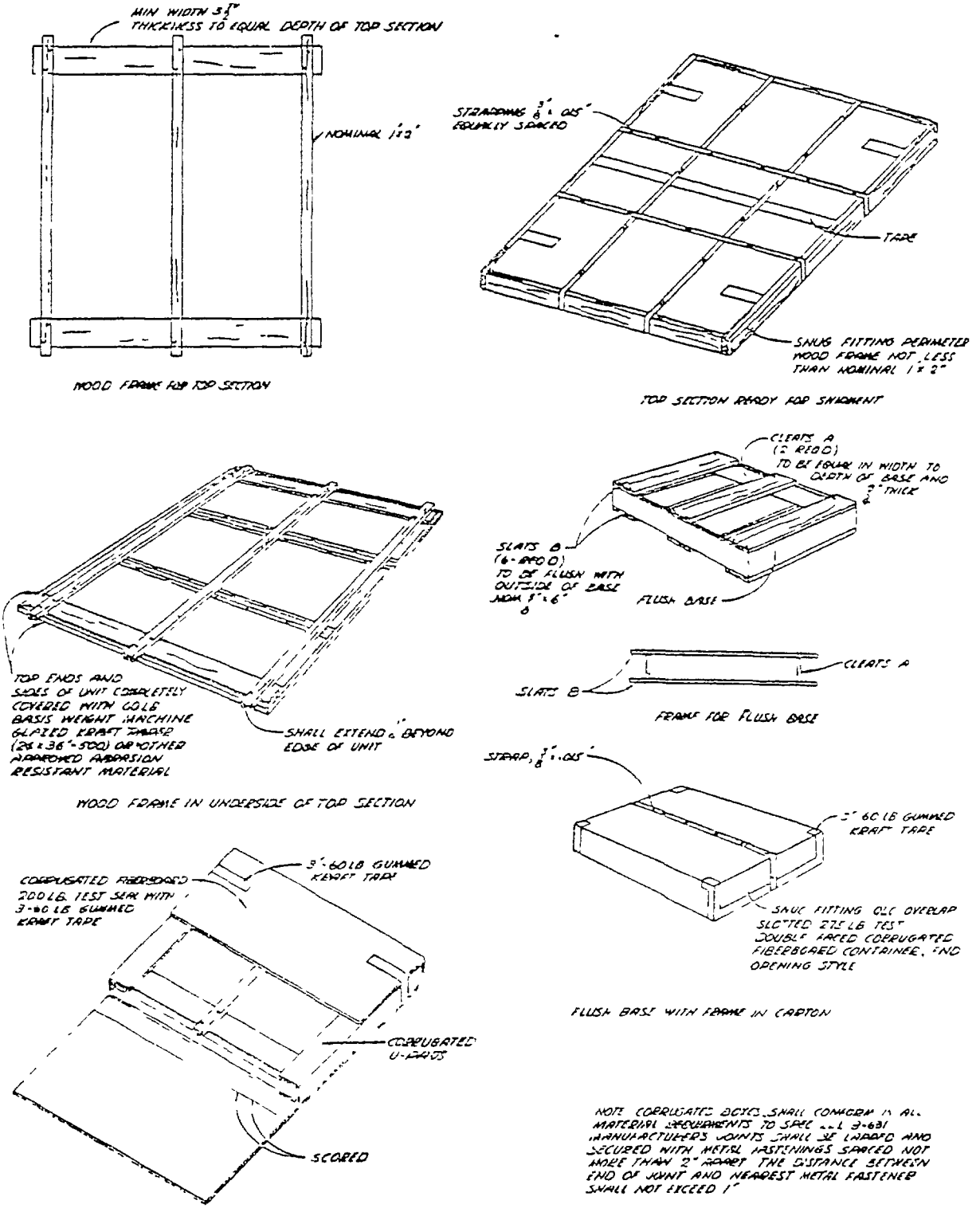


FIGURE 2 —Packaging and packing for domestic shipment filing cabinet, steel, map and plan

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blocking with wood blocks or cleats not less than 1⅝ inches thick. The blocks shall be wide enough to provide necessary clearance The handle shall clear the side of the crate by not less than 1 inch Both sides shall be provided with the same blocks (These will serve as interior battens as specified in Military Specification JAN-P-132.)

5.3.2.2 The drawer section, prepared as specified above, shall be packed in a style C nailed wood crate conforming to Military Specification JAN-P-132, except that the bottom shall be solid and provided with 2 x 4 skids nailed flat one at each end of the crate The width limitations, as specified in Military Specification JAN-P-132, shall be waived Prior to packing the top of each crate shall be lined with a sheet of double-faced corrugated fiberboard with a minimum bursting strength of 200 p s i to prevent rupture of cushioning materials Each crate shall be strapped as specified in Appendix I Military Specification JAN-P-132

5.3.3 Each base shall be provided with a wood frame and then placed into a corrugated fiberboard shipping container as specified on figure 2 and in accordance with Federal Specification LLL-B-631

5.4 For export shipment—commercial.—When specified, subject commodity shall be packed in containers which together with packaging, wrapping and inner packing, are acceptable by ocean-going vessels for safe transportation to the points of destination specified in the shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies

5.5 For export shipment — military — When specified

5.5.1 The top section shall be packed and strapped for overseas shipment in the same manner as that specified for domestic shipment and storage, except that all fiberboard used shall conform to compliance symbol V3c or V3s, Military Specification JAN-P-108, and tape used shall conform to type II or III, grade C, Military Specification JAN-P-127

5.5.2 Each drawer section shall be prepared for overseas shipment in the same manner as specified for domestic shipment and storage Cabinet shall be further protected for overseas shipment by a waterproof shroud fabricated in conformance with the material requirements of grade B class 2, type L-2 of Military Specification MIL-L-10547 The dimensions of the set-up shroud shall be based on the over-all length and width of the cushioned cabinet and extending over the sides and ends to the base of the piece The top of the crate shall be lined with a fiberboard sheet conforming to Military Specification JAN-P-108, compliance symbol V3c or V3s.

5.5.3 Each base shall be packed and strapped for overseas shipment in the same manner as specified for domestic shipment and storage, except that the fiberboard container shall conform to compliance symbol V3c or V3s Military Specification JAN-P-108, and that all flaps shall be securely sealed with water-resistant adhesive conforming to Military Specification MIL-A-101 applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps instead of with gummed kraft tape

5.6 Marking.—Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, shipping containers shall be clearly marked with the name of the item, the unit the size and the color of the commodity, the Federal stock number, the name of the contractor the number of the contract or order and the full name and address of the consignee

5.6.1 On military procurements, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129 The approved item name is "Filing Cabinet Steel Map and Plan, _____ unit, _____ size _____ color"

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.—Purchaser should specify the unit, size, and color of finish, and if locks, drawer covers, or partitions are required and should exercise any of the desired options offered herein (see 1 2 1, 1.2 2, 3 1 2 4, 3 2 5.2, 3 2 5.3, 3 2 5 4, 3 4 1 section 5, and 6.3)

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NOTE.—Drawers are not interchangeable between manufacturers, therefore locks, partitions and fabric covers should be purchased as original equipment only

6.2 Federal specifications do not include all the types, classes grades, sizes, etc, of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types etc which are suitable for Federal Government requirements

6.3 **Preproduction sample.**—When specified and before production is commenced, a complete unit shall be made available to the contracting officer for his approval, either at the contractor's plant or at such other place as designated When the preproduction sample is approved it shall be retained by the inspector as a control guide for subsequent production on the contract The approved sample may be included as a part of the last shipment

6.4 **Transportation description.** — Transportation description applicable to this item is

Filing cabinets not otherwise indexed by name steel with hollow walls or with solid walls less than 1" thick (indicate set-up or knocked-down)

Carload minimum weights In cars 40'9" or less in length, inside measurements, 10,000, 12.000, 15,000, 18.000, 22.000, 30,000 pounds.

In cars exceeding 40'9" in length, 16.000, 18 000, 21.000 24.000, 30,000, 40.000 pounds

Truckload minimum weights Set-up—24 000 pounds Knocked-down flat—30 000 pounds

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever, and the fact that the Government may have formulated furnished or in any way supplied the said drawings specifications or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto

MILITARY INTERESTS

Army—Q E

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Air Force.

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